BlueFairy Forms

Installation & Features Guide

Zero-asset-bloat WordPress forms with Anti-Spam integration, GDPR-safe storage, rate limiting, and no jQuery.

FREE

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Requirements & Installation

Requirement	Minimum

PHP	8.1+
WordPress	6.4+
BlueFairy Anti-Spam	Optional (strongly recommended)

1. Upload `bluefairy-forms/` to `wp-content/plugins/`
2. Activate via **Plugins > Installed Plugins**
3. A default “Contact” form (ID 1) is created automatically
4. Place `[bluefairy_form id="1"]` on any page — done

Quick Start

Shortcode

```
[bluefairy_form id="1"]
```

Replace `1` with the form ID shown in **Tools > Forms**.

Gutenberg Block

In the block editor, add a new block and search for **BlueFairy Form**. Select it and enter your form ID in the block sidebar.

Form Fields Reference

Field type	JSON `type`	Notes
Single-line text	`text`	Supports `minlength`, `maxlength`, `pattern`
Email	`email`	Browser + server validation
Telephone	`tel`	
URL	`url`	
Number	`number`	
Date	`date`	
Textarea	`textarea`	Supports `minlength`, `maxlength`

Dropdown	`select`	Requires `options` array
Radio buttons	`radio`	Requires `options` array
Checkbox	`checkbox`	Single checkbox, value = 1

Example config JSON

```
{
  "schema_version": "1.0",
  "submit_label": "Send Message",
  "success_message": "Thank you! Your message has been sent.",
  "consent_text": "I agree to the privacy policy.",
  "redirect_url": "/thank-you/",
  "fields": [
    { "id": "name",    "type": "text",     "label": "Your Name",     "required": true },
    { "id": "email",   "type": "email",    "label": "Email Address", "required": true },
    { "id": "message", "type": "textarea", "label": "Message",       "required": true }
  ]
}
```

Anti-Spam Integration

When **BlueFairy Anti-Spam** is active, BlueFairy Forms delegates all spam checking to it via two hooks:

- `do_action('bluefairy_antispam_render_fields', $form_type)` — renders honeypot and time-trap hidden fields
- `apply_filters('bluefairy_antispam_check', false, $post_data, $form_type, $ip, $email)` — returns true if spam

Form type: `bffrm_{form_id}` (e.g. `bffrm_1`). Anti-Spam logs all blocks to its own log table.

An admin notice appears in **Tools > Forms** when Anti-Spam is not active.

Spam Protection Fallback

Without Anti-Spam, a self-contained honeypot and time-trap protects every form:

- **Honeypot:** a hidden field drawn from a pool of 8 realistic names; bots that fill it are blocked.
- **Time trap:** an HMAC-SHA256 token records page load time; submissions under 3 seconds are blocked.

Rate Limiting

Each form enforces a per-IP rate limit via atomic `INSERT … ON DUPLICATE KEY UPDATE` on `bffrm_rate_limits`. Window: 1 minute. Default max: 5 per IP per form per minute (configurable).

Submissions Log

Column	Notes
ID	Auto-increment
Form	Form title
Submitted At	UTC `datetime(6)`
Email	Plain text if provided; also stored as HMAC hash
Status	`new` | `read` | `archived`
View	Full payload

Admin Email Notifications

On every new submission, the admin receives a plain-text email with the form name, submission ID, all field values, and a direct admin link. Recipient configurable in Settings.

GDPR Tools

- **Exporter** — exports all submissions matching a user's email
- **Eraser** — deletes matching submissions; IP hash is retained (cannot be reversed)

Both accessible via **Tools > Export / Erase Personal Data**.

Audit Log

Action	When
`submission.created`	New submission saved

`form.created` / `updated` / `deleted`	Admin form CRUD
`submission.deleted`	Admin deletes a submission

WP-CLI Reference

```
wp bluefairy-forms doctor
```

Verifies all four tables (`bffrm_forms` , `bffrm_submissions` , `bffrm_rate_limits` , `bffrm_audit_log`) exist and reports OK or MISSING for each.

Settings Reference

Setting	Default	Description
Notification email	Site admin email	Where new-submission alerts are sent
Rate limit max hits	5	Max submissions per IP per minute per form

Multisite

All four tables are created for each subsite automatically on `wp_initialize_site` . Each subsite uses its own table prefix.

Frequently Asked Questions

Does it load jQuery or external scripts?

No. The front-end form is pure HTML. No JavaScript is enqueued on pages without a BlueFairy Form block or shortcode.

Can I redirect to a thank-you page?

Yes — add `"redirect_url": "/thank-you/"` to the form config JSON.

What you are missing

Everything in this guide is the free plugin. **BlueFairy Forms Pro** is where the plugin stops being a contact form and starts being infrastructure — encrypted submissions, webhooks into your own systems, CSV export, file uploads, and CAPTCHA that actually stops determined bots.

Feature	Pro	Free
Encryption at rest (libsodium, with key rotation)	Yes	—
Webhooks with HMAC signature and retry	Yes	—
Streamed CSV export	Yes	—
File uploads with MIME validation	Yes	—
CAPTCHA (reCAPTCHA v3, hCaptcha, Turnstile)	Yes	—
HTML confirmation emails to the submitter	Yes	—
Custom From header and multiple recipients	Yes	—
Form scheduling and submission limits	Yes	—
Dashboard submission stats widget	Yes	—
Forms, Gutenberg block and shortcode	Yes	Yes
Spam protection and rate limiting	Yes	Yes
GDPR-safe storage, export and erasure	Yes	Yes

If you are storing anything a person would mind losing — enquiries, applications, anything with a name and an email attached — it is sitting in your database in plain text right now. Pro encrypts it, and gives you the export and integration tools to do something useful with it.

Get BlueFairy Forms Pro — wordpress.bluefairydevelopment.com/product/bluefairy-forms-pro/
Installs alongside this plugin. Keep BlueFairy Forms active and your existing forms, submissions and settings carry straight over — nothing to migrate.

License & Support

GPL-2.0-or-later. Free.

Support: create an account at bluefairydevelopment.com/my-account/ and submit a support ticket.

Bug reports: github.com/bluefairydevelopment/bluefairy-forms